

Inclusive Schools & Teaching Practice

Professional Studies Workshop



St Mary's
University
Twickenham
London
School of
Education

Session Objectives:

Build on Professional Studies lecture and ensure trainees are fully aware of:

- their duties in respect of equalities legislation. (part 2)
- how to create respectful cultures within their classrooms where pupils feel motivated and valued. (part 2)
- how Fundamental British Values can be upheld in schools and the importance of showing tolerance and respect for the rights of others. (part 2)

DO NOW:

Which statutory frameworks and legal guidelines shape your responsibilities for Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) in schools?

Can you identify the '9 Protected Characteristics'?

DEI(B) work is about your...

- Legal compliance



Equality Act 2010

Department
for Education

- Safeguarding duties

Keeping children
safe in education
2025

Statutory guidance for schools and
colleges. Part one: Information for all
school and college staff

September 2025

- Professional Standards



Protected Characteristics of the Equality Act (2010)

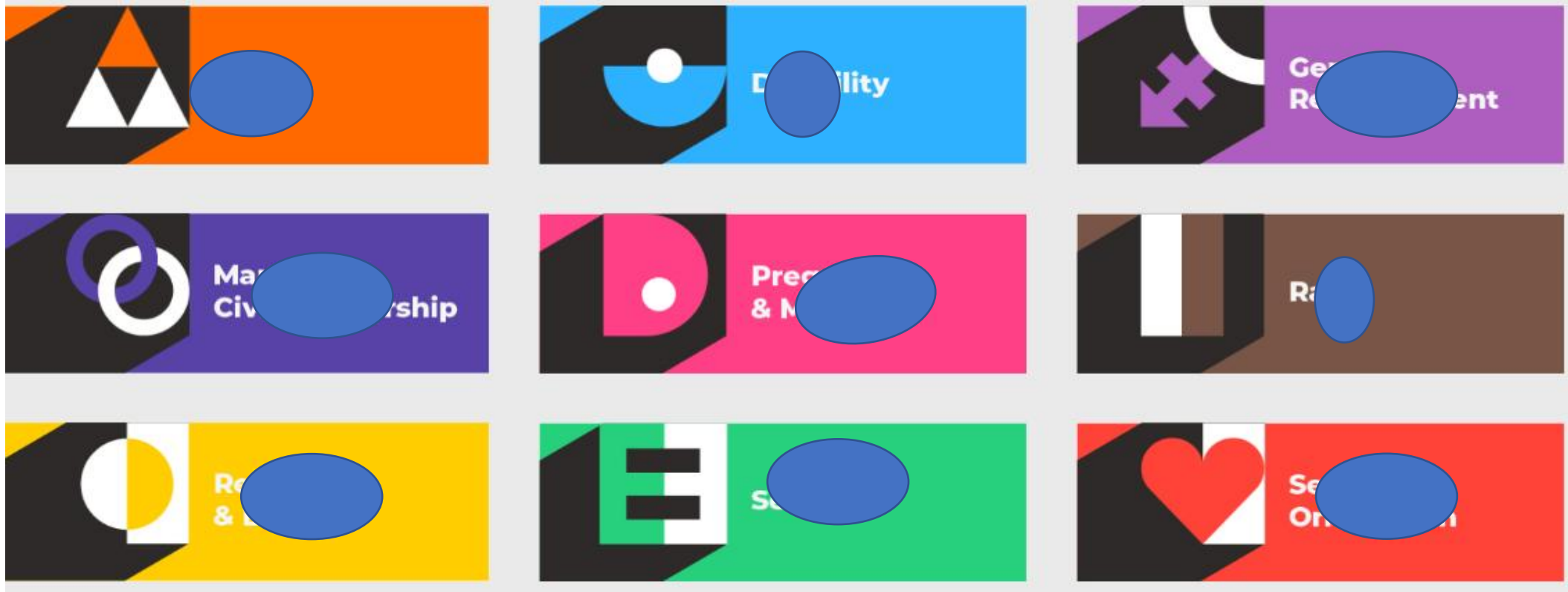


Image: Diverse Educators

PLEASE DISCUSS: How do your schools promote a safe and stimulating learning environment for pupils with one/more Protected Characteristic?

You were asked to...

carry out a whole school EDI learning walk and observe how the Protected Characteristics (e.g Race, Sex, Sexual Orientation, Disability etc) as outlined by the Equality Act are represented visually through school displays, promotional materials, noticeboards etc. (EDI Task 2, Part 1)

TASK: Discuss your findings on your tables.

In relation to your own school contexts, share your observations around how groups/individuals with Protected Characteristics are represented in (whole school) visual displays, promotional materials, noticeboards etc.

You might also discuss school (anti-racism/anti-homophobia/anti-sexism) policies; messaging in assemblies/form time.

You will be asked to **feedback with positive examples that were shared on your table.**

PLEASE TELL US: How do your subjects/departments promote a safe and stimulating learning experience for pupils with a/more Protected Characteristic(s)?



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You were asked to...

carry out a department EDI visual review to consider how groups/individuals with Protected Characteristics are represented in subject display boards, teaching resources (PPTs, worksheets), textbooks etc. (EDI Task 2, Part 2)

TASK : *where possible* with trainee(s) from the same subject as you discuss your observations

Prompts to support discussion:

- How far do displays/visual aids include images that reflect our diverse communities?
- Are there positive examples of role models from diverse backgrounds?
- How far do textbook images of women/disability/People of Colour in my subject go beyond/confront/compound tokenistic and stereotypical representations?
- **Can you identify any areas that may lend themselves to exploring issues of anti-racism/anti-homophobia/gender equality in your subject curriculum further?**

Schemes of Work – EDI review



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TASK: With reference to your own SoW, think about and discuss

How might a pupil with one/more PC/intersectional identities experience your SoW?

Are there any areas that may cause harm/distress/trauma to pupils?

Can you identify any curriculum areas that may lend themselves to exploring issues of anti-racism/anti-homophobia/gender equality/disability awareness?

Are there opportunities to promote positive examples of role models from diverse backgrounds?

How might the representation of women/People of Colour/disability etc go beyond/confront/compound tokenistic and stereotypical representations?

Where are the areas for development?

Barriers and Opportunities

- **What are the barriers to making the advancements in the areas you have identified?** (e.g. constraints in terms of time; autonomy to make changes at this stage or support from colleagues/school; lack of confidence/training in the area etc.).
- **Where opportunities are available to you (now) to contribute to meaningful advancements in this area of your practice?** (e.g. adaptations to lesson resources; identifying areas of the curriculum which might cause trauma and taking steps to eliminate/minimise harm; critical conversations with pupils; discussions with mentor during WTM; engaging with subject/community networks; engaging in professional training etc.).
- **What are your first actions/next steps?** (e.g. identifying your blind spots; examining your biases; reading/research; [Diverse Educators](#) support resource bank).

SUMMARY

- It is our responsibility as teachers to ensure that all of our students receive a safe and stimulating learning experience at school.
- Our EDI duties are enshrined in law.
- Developing an informed approach to educating your pupils by acknowledging and embracing inclusive practices WILL improve your teaching their learning!
- Effective professional development is sustained over time (CCF 8) and so try to think about your increasing awareness as a steady progressive journey over the year and the course of your future career.

Suggested reading to support next steps

- Arday, J. (2020). The Black Curriculum. Retrieved from [Report — The Black Curriculum](#)
- Department for Education (2024) Schools, pupils and their characteristics. Academic year 2023/24. Retrieved from [Schools, pupils and their characteristics, Academic year 2023/24 - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK](#)
- Kara, B., & Wilson, H. (2022) Diverse Educators: A Manifesto
- [NSPCC Safeguarding LGBTQ+ children and young people | NSPCC Learning](#)
- [NSPCC Safeguarding children from Black, Asian and minoritised ethnic communities | NSPCC Learning](#)
- Smith, J., Lander, V., Anti-racism framework for Initial Teacher Education [Home | AntiRacism Framework](#)